who had been teaching in Paris for years and had just been made a cardinal in Rome. Innocent had not asked for John's approval, and John flew into a convenient rage: He knew nothing of Langton, he told the pope, except that the man had "dwelt much among his enemies," and he was incensed that Innocent had not bothered to ask for his consent to the appointment. "He added," says Roger of Wendover, "that he would stand up for the rights of his crown, if necessary, even to death." He then refused to allow Langton to enter England, and confiscated all of Canterbury's estates—and their revenue—for himself.[9]

Innocent at once put the entire country under interdict, which did not bother John in the slightest. Instead, he confiscated more church property, under the excuse that the clergy who held them only did so on condition that they perform their job, which they obviously could not do under current conditions.[10]

The interdict dragged on, and the people of England suffered. "All church services ceased," writes Roger of Wendover; ". . . the bodies of the dead too were carried out of cities and towns, and buried in roads and ditches without prayers or the attendance of priests."[11]

Meanwhile, John went on refilling the royal coffers. His ongoing quarrel with Philip gave him another way to raise revenue: confiscation of the lands of those English nobles he suspected of divided loyalties. One such was Simon de Montfort, who inherited the English title Earl of Leicester from his uncle, but who was himself born near Paris, son of the Count of Montfort-l'Amaury. Under the excuse that de Montfort was bound to be a vassal of the king of France, John allowed him to inherit the title, but in late 1207, took the lands for himself; and de Montfort joined the growing rank of Englishmen who hated their king.

Over the next five years, John socked away an astonishing amount of tax money, confiscated treasure, and church funds. In 1210, he followed Philip's example and ordered all the Jews in England imprisoned, "in order to do [his] will with their money." Those who resisted were brutalized; a rabbi in Bristol, refusing to pay up, had one tooth knocked out by John's men every morning for a week before he gave up and agreed to hand over his savings. "The corn of the clergy was every where locked up . . . for the benefit of the revenue," Roger of Wendover tells us, and everywhere barons were forced to pay the king fines for trespasses as small as putting a fish weir into a river without John's express permission. Resentment built, and built, and built. By 1213, it had hit a fever height and the king knew it.

He did not reform his financial policies, though. Instead, he "began to suspect everyone," says the contemporary *Barnwell Chronicle*, "and went